Focus Traps

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

A focus trap keeps keyboard focus inside one part of the page while it's open, such as a modal. Pressing Tab only moves between the items inside it, so the user doesn't get lost on the page behind it. A good focus trap always lets the user leave, for example by pressing Escape or using a close button.

How to support it

Only use a focus trap where it's needed, such as in a modal. Unwanted traps can be added by accident. Always test your pages using only the keyboard before any changes go live.

If you genuinely want a focus trap, use a pre-built accessible component like a Modal, which handles focus trap behaviour automatically.

Useful Links

A Primer on Focus Trapping

How to Build Accessible Modals with Focus Traps